TOWN OF MOUNT PLEASANT, SOUTH CAROLINA
BOARD OF ZONING APPEALS
SEPTEMBER 28, 2026
MINUTES

Staff Report

Present: Stephen Wood, Chair, Megan Stevens, Elliott Barrow, Brian Stress, Cheryll Woods-Flowers, Joan Spier, Giles Branch.
Staff: Matt Simms, Brent Leary, Lynnette Lynes

Mr. Wood called to order at 6:00 pm.

A. Approval of Agenda

▶ *Ms. Stevens moved for approval of the agenda. Mr. Branch seconded the motion. All in favor.*

B. Approval of Minutes

▶ *Ms. Woods-Flowers moved for approval of the minutes. Mr. Branch seconded the motion. All in favor.*

C. Public Comment
D. General Correspondence

There being no comments, Mr. Wood continued with the agenda. All correspondence was linked to the agenda.

E. Explanation of Procedures
F. Administration of Oath

▶ Mr. Wood reviewed the procedures with the public and administered the oath to those speaking.

G. Business

1. Case V-18-2026**, 960 McCants Drive, TMS# 532-07-00-031,** Request relief from the strict application of §156.025(B) to allow the subdivision of one existing lot into two residential lots, yielding two dwelling units. Based on the density calculation in §156.1616, the subject property is permitted a maximum of one dwelling unit.

- Ms. Woods-Flowers recused herself due to a conflict of interest.

- Mr. Simms reviewed staff comments with the Board.

- Mr. Wood asked if there are two structures on the property. Mr. Simms answered that it is one main structure. Mr. Wood asked if the request is to demolish a portion of the main structure to create two structures. Mr. Simms answered in the affirmative.

- Ms. Carol Williams, owner, reviewed the request with the Board.

- Mr. Branch asked if the owner currently lives in the residence. Ms. Williams answered in the affirmative. Mr. Branch asked about the front portion of the residence. Ms. Williams answered that it is currently used as a workshop. Mr. Branch asked if the desire is to sell the property. Ms. Williams answered that this is one option; another would be to rent the front as a separate structure.

- Mr. Wood asked how the property is prohibiting utilization of the property. Ms. Williams answered that the configuration restricts the best use of the property. Mr. Wood asked if the entire main structure was in place when the property was purchased. Ms. Williams answered in the negative and stated that they built the addition.

- Mr. Barrow asked if when purchased, the owner has lived in the structure. Ms. Williams answered that they have occupied the structure since 2020. Prior to inhabiting the structure, they rented the property, which was only the bungalow at that time. She stated that after 2020, they decided to construct the addition. Mr. Barrow asked when the addition was constructed. Ms. Williams answered that the addition was constructed in 2022. Since the Town only allowed one structure on the property, the addition was constructed and connected to the main bungalow structure. Mr. Barrow asked if 952 is approximately the size of their property. Ms. Williams answered that it is slightly smaller. Mr. Barrow asked if 966 is a larger lot. Ms. Williams answered in the affirmative. Mr. Barrow asked if there are other properties in the vicinity that are larger than their property. Ms. Williams answered in the affirmative.

There being no further questions, Mr. Wood closed public comment.

▶ *Mr. Barrow moved for denial based on the findings that the criteria to grant a variance has not been met, particularly the unreasonable restriction of utilization of the property as the owner has been living in the residence and the home utilized since constructed in the 1940s, and there are no extraordinary or special conditions. Mr. Branch seconded the motion. All in favor.*

2. Case V-19-2026**, 316 Royall Avenue, TMS# 532-05-00-077**, Request relief from the strict application of § 156.203(D)(3) to allow a Building Area Ratio (BAR) of 71.5%. The ordinance restricts BAR to no more than 50% of the lot area. Correspondence

▶ Mr. Simms reviewed staff comments with the Board.

▶ Mr. Samuel Wilson, owner, reviewed the request with the Board.

▶ Ms. Ethel Fludd, 440 Morrison St, stated that she is in favor of the request. She stated that the property has been well-maintained prior to the fire. She asked that the variance be granted.

▶ Ms. Pearl Ascue, 977 Gadsdenville Road, stated that she is in favor of the request. She stated that her family and the owner's family has a long history of growing together in MP. She asked that the structure be allowed to be increased to better accommodate the family needs. She suggested that this increase would not be a detriment to the property. She asked the audience to stand in favor of the request

▶ Ms. Barbara Smith, 410 Royall Ave, stated that she is in favor of the request and has lived next to the Wilsons since 1972. She suggested that many homes have been sold to developers and then demolished and flipped. She stated that this is not a developer, but a long-time family. She suggested that the footprint would not change; only the configuration of the second floor to make it a full second story. She suggested that the new ordinances put in place unreasonably restricts the ability for the Wilson's to effectively utilize their property for their family. She asked that the request be approved.

▶ Mr. Michael Toluccio, architect for the Wilson's, stated that the new structure would better accommodate the extended family that will be living in

the structure. He stated that during his due diligence at the end of 2025, the new BAR ordinance was not in place. It was after the plans were completely drafted and submitted, that they were made aware of the BAR. He stated that there was no timeframe to allow for plans already in progress to be reviewed and approved without having to meet the ordinance changes.

▶ Mr. Wood asked when first reading of the new ordinance was held. Mr. Simms answered that first reading was held in November 2025. Mr. Wood asked when the house fire occurred. Mr. Wood asked when the fire occurred. Mr. Simms answered that it was in June 2025. Mr. Wood asked the status of the home prior to the fire and the square footage of the home prior to the fire. Mr. Wilson answered that the second floor was not an entire second story and portions of the second floor were not usable due to the configuration of the walls. Ms. Woods-Flowers stated that there is a five foot wall rule. Mr. Wood asked how many bedrooms the home had prior to the fire. Mr. Wilson answered that there were five bedrooms prior to the fire. He stated that they are a asking for six bedrooms, with two of them being located upstairs.

▶ Mr. Barrow asked the square footage of the home prior to the fire. Mr. Wilson answered that it was approximately 2,000 square feet. Mr. Barrow stated that the plans submitted shows 2873 square feet. Mr. Barrow asked if the same footprint would be utilized. Mr. Simms answered in the affirmative. Mr. Barrow asked how the BAR is calculated and what square footage calculation is used. Mr. Simms referred to the plans and reviewed this with the Board. Mr. Barrow asked if the issue is that the second floor is being increased. Mr. Simms answered in the affirmative and suggested that the footprint of the home is 2521 square feet. Mr. Barrow asked about the discrepancy between the different square footage indicated on the plans and what figure should be used. Mr. Simms answered that the 2521 square foot calculation should be used. Mr. Barrow asked about §156.1541 that states that the structure cannot be re-constructed with greater total habitable floor area that existed prior to the damage and suggested that this is a matter of concern.

▶ Mr. Wood asked about calculating the BAR. Mr. Simms showed the BAR calculation on the plans. Mr. Wood asked if the garage is included in the BAR. Mr. Simms answered in the affirmative. Mr. Wood asked the square footage of the garage. Mr. Simms answered that it is approximately 1600 square feet. Mr. Wood asked if there are additional bedrooms in the garage. Mr. Toluccio

answered in the affirmative and stated that the garage was constructed on the adjacent property that was later combined with this lot. Mr. Wood asked if there would be a total of seven bedrooms. Mr. Wilson answered in the affirmative.

- Ms. Woods-Flowers asked if the additional square footage would be approximately 200 square feet on the second story. Mr. Simms answered in the affirmative.

- Mr. Barrow asked if they constructed the home as original prior to the fire, would a variance be needed. Mr. Simms answered in the negative.

- Mr. Wood asked the square footage of the second floor prior to the fire. Ms. Tolucio answered it was 417 square feet. Mr. Wood asked if that means an additional 1800 square feet would be added to the second floor. Mr. Toluccio answered in the affirmative.

- Mr. Branch asked if a five foot second story could be constructed that meets building code. Mr. Toluccio answered in the negative and stated that the minimum height is seven feet.

- Mr. Wood asked if there was originally 400 square feet on the second story. Mr. Barrow concurred.

- *Mr. Branch moved for approval based on the findings that there are exceptional conditions as the footprint of the structure prior to the fire is the same as being requested, it is the only home in area that has burned, denial would prohibit utilization of the property due to the timing of the fire and enactment of the new ordinance restricting BAR, and there is no detriment to the surrounding neighborhood as many neighbors are in favor of the request.*

- Ms. Woods-Flowers stated that it is refreshing to see an owner wanting to reconstruct their historical family home and maintain its integrity.

Mr. Wood stated that there are no extraordinary conditions and that the home can be built without a variance to the original footprint. He stated that if not constrained by the criteria, the variance could be granted.

- Mr. Barrow suggested that the third criteria has been met as denial would not unreasonably restrict the utilization of the property as a home can be built on the property; however, under the equities of this situation the request should be granted.

- *Mr. Wood called for a vote on the motion. Motion passed on a 4 to 3 vote with Mr. Stress, Ms. Woods-Flowers, Ms. Stevens and Mr. Branch in favor; Mr. Barrow, Ms. Spier, and Mr. Wood opposed.*

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 6:57 pm.

Submitted by,
L. Lynes
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